Becoming an IR Rock Star

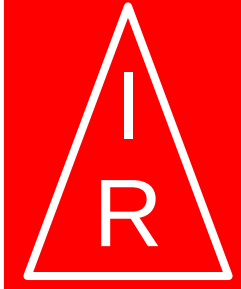
(Superstars 2.0)



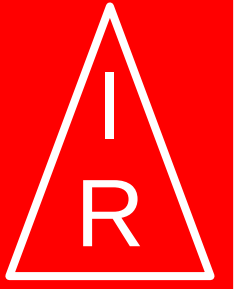
Matt Scheurer

October 16, 2026






```
if (badEvent == "true") {
  perform = "Incident Response";
}
```



About Me

I work for a big well-known organization...



As Vice President (VP) of Computer Security and Incident Response (IR). However, I have many years of hands-on technical experience, including Digital Forensics & Incident Response (DFIR).

https://www.linkedin.com/in/mattscheurer

https://x.com/c3rkah

Where I volunteer...

I am an Official



Advocate
https://www.hackingisnotacrime.org



Advisory Board: Information Technology and Cybersecurity
https://www.mywccc.org



Women's Security Alliance (WomSA) Technical Mentor
https://www.womsa.org

Disclaimer!

Yes, I have a day job. However…

Opinions expressed are based solely on my own independent security research and do not express or reflect the views or opinions of my employer.



Agenda

1) Incident Response (IR) Essentials

2) Q&A

Slide Deck



https://slides.dfirmatt.com

Why this talk?

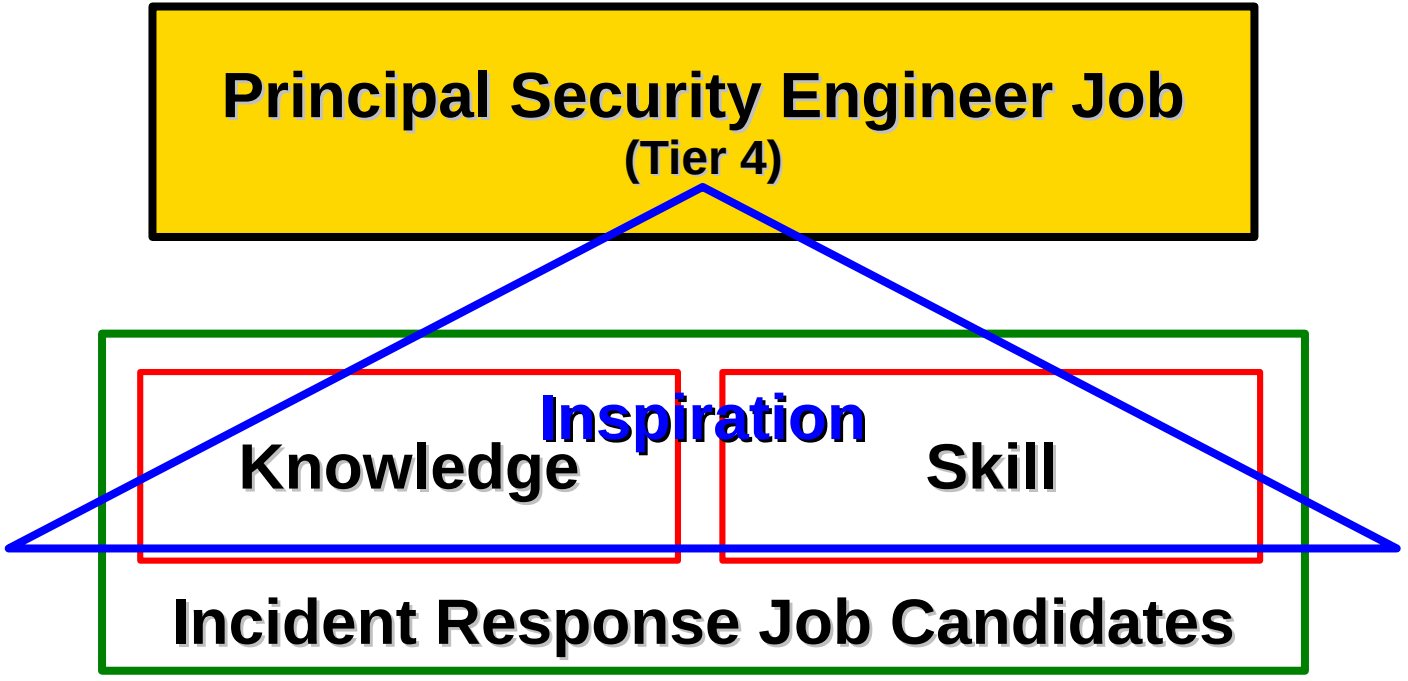
Principal Security Engineer Job
(Tier 4)

Knowledge

Skill

Incident Response Job Candidates

Why this talk?



Role of Incident Response

?

¯_(ツ)_/¯

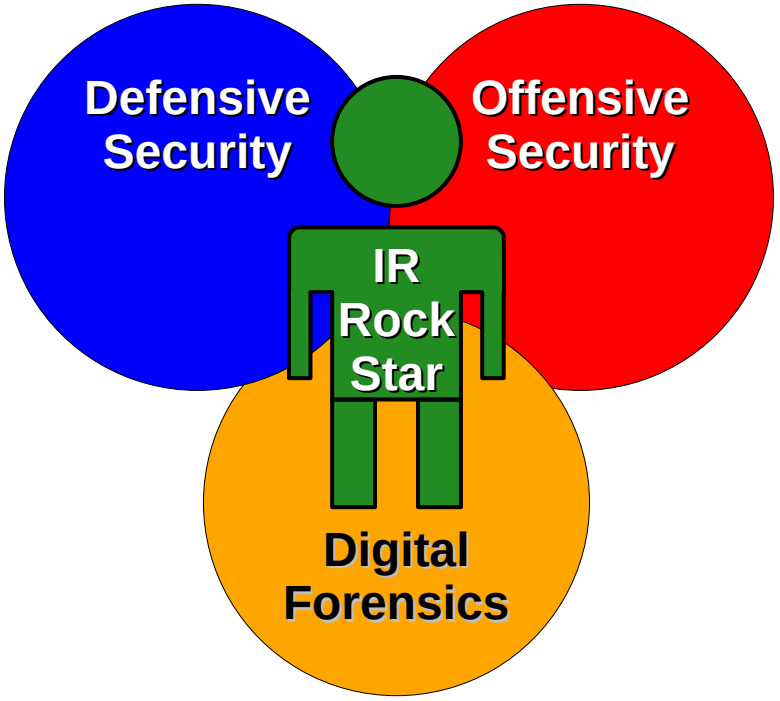
Security Investigation

- Who
- What
- When
- Where
- Why
- How

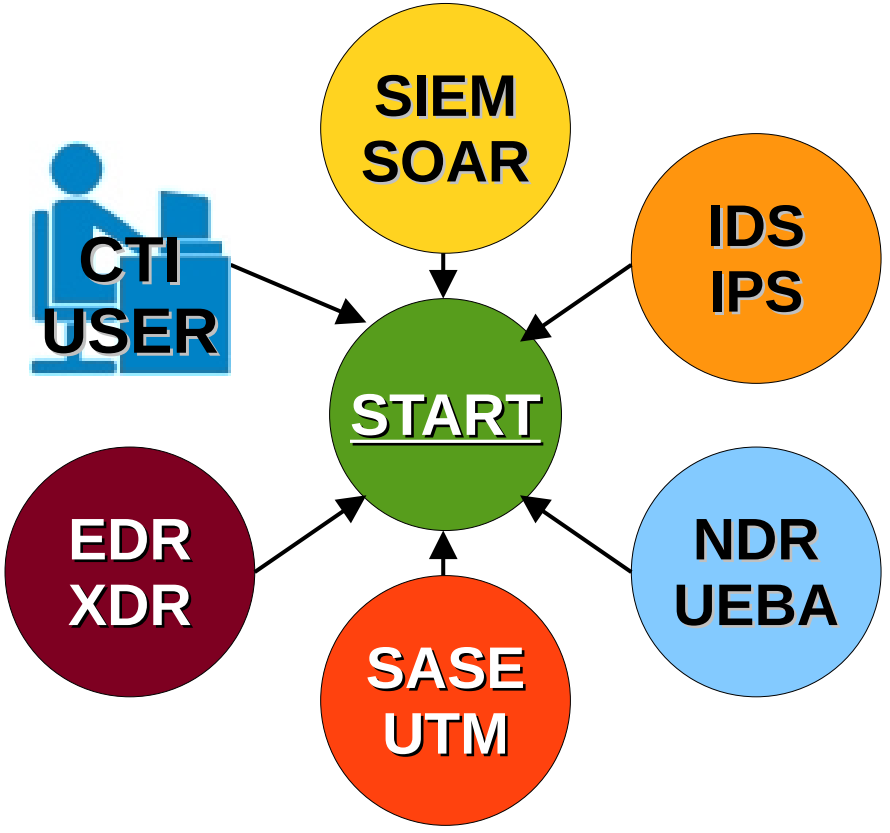
Aspiring Incident Responders



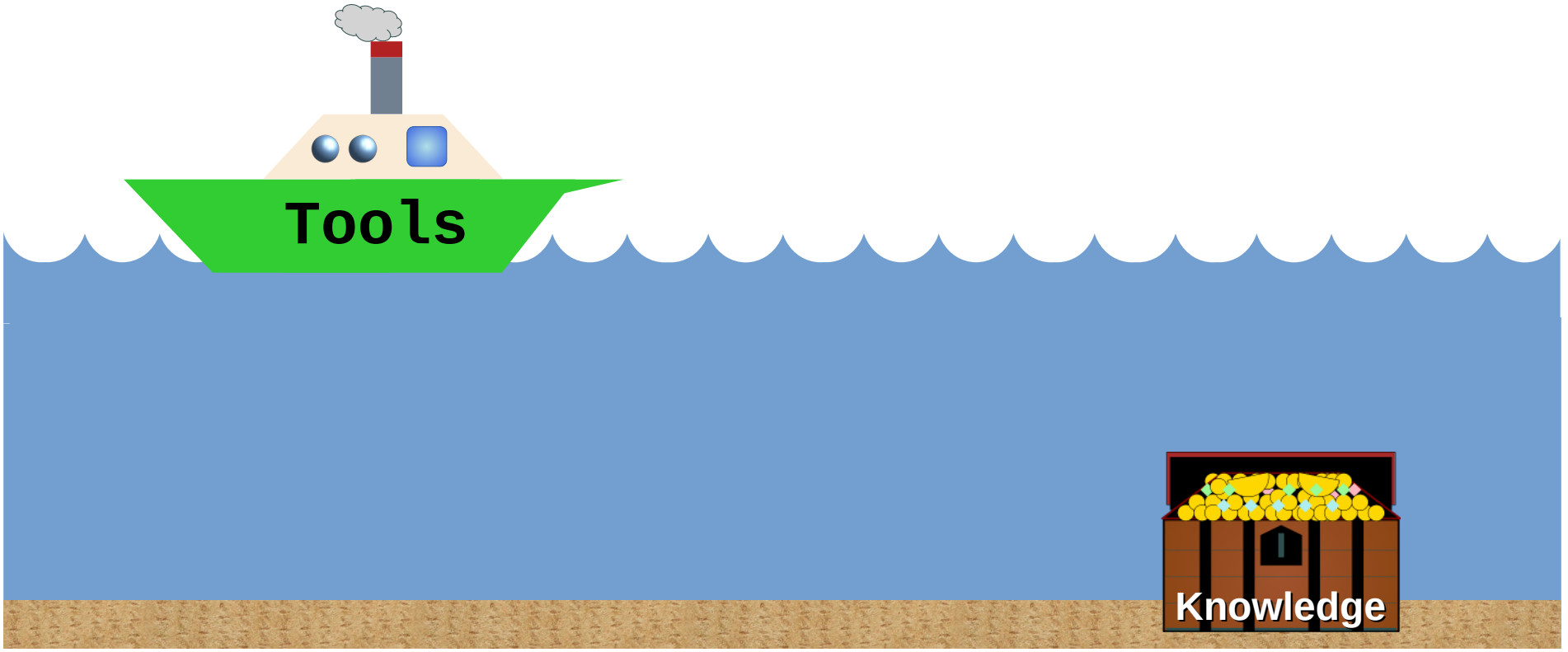
Incident Responders



When IR starts



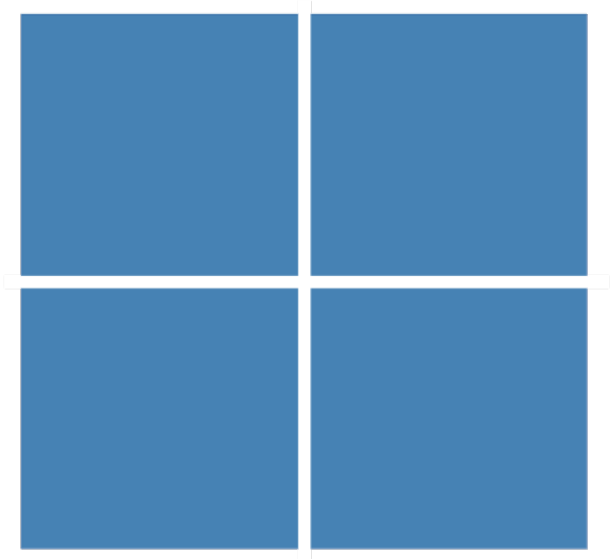
Diving Deep

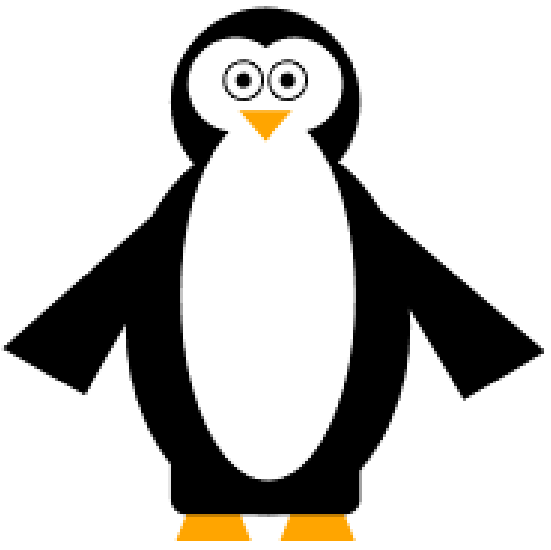


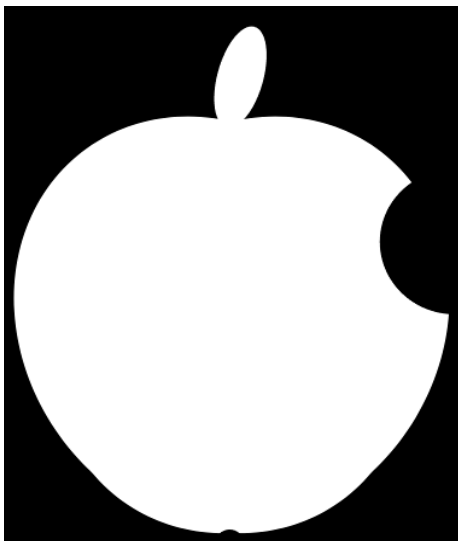
Alert Dispositions

	True (Detection)	False (Detection)
Positive (Condition)	**True Positive:** Correctly classifying malicious activity as malicious	**False Positive:** Incorrectly classifying benign activity as malicious
Negative (Condition)	**True Negative:** Correctly classifying benign activity as benign	**False Negative:** Incorrectly classifying malicious activity as benign

Operating Systems





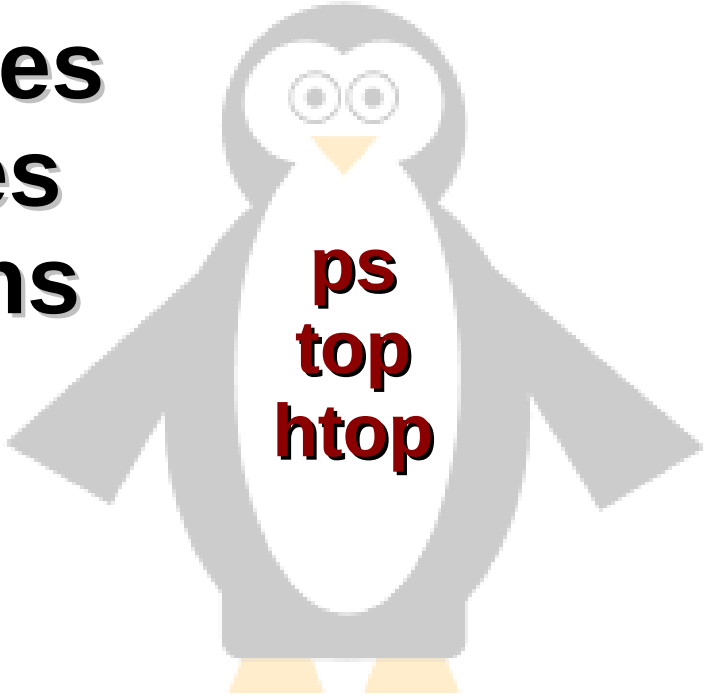


OS Processes & More

Task Manager
(taskmgr.exe)

Services
(services.msc)

Processes
Services
Daemons



Default User directory

C:\Users\<USERNAME>

%UserProfile%



/home/<USERNAME>

Windows Filesystem

Configuration

Registry (regedit.exe)

Hive files

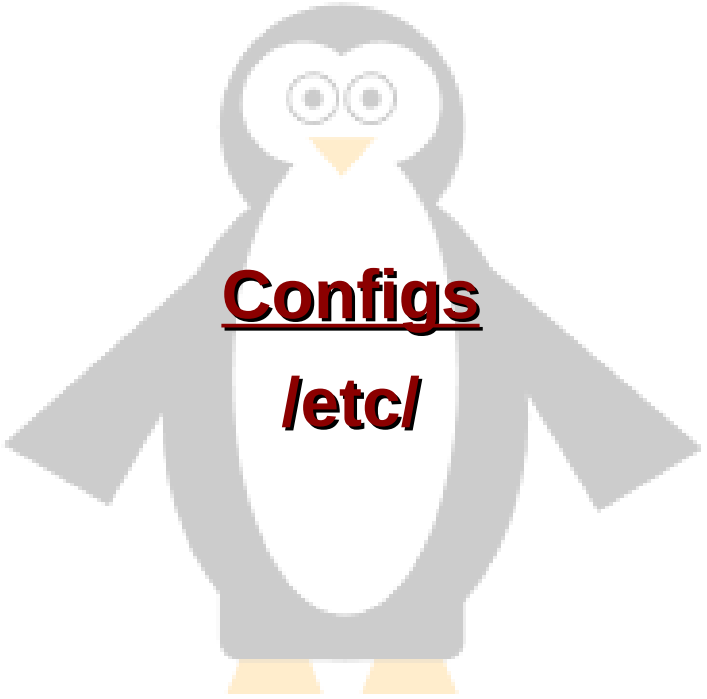
C:\Windows\System32\

- \config
- \config\RegBack

%UserProfile%

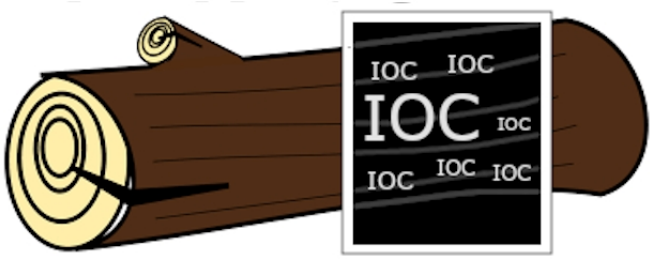
- \NTUSER.DAT

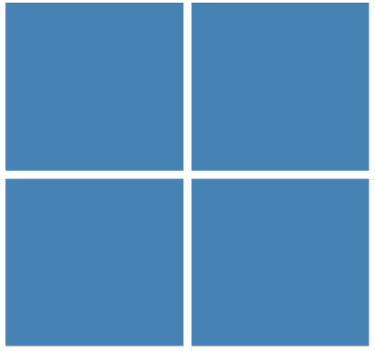
Linux Filesystem



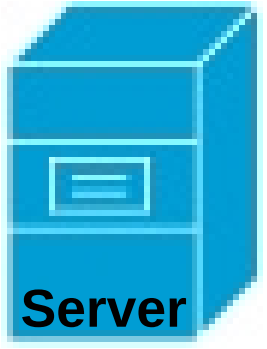
- Linux Foundation
  - Filesystem Hierarchy Standard (FHS)

Various Log files









Apps

Windows Logs

Application

Security

Setup

System

etc.

C:\Windows\System32\winevt\Logs

- %System32%
- ***.evtx**

Event Viewer	(eventvwr.exe)
Event ID	Logon type





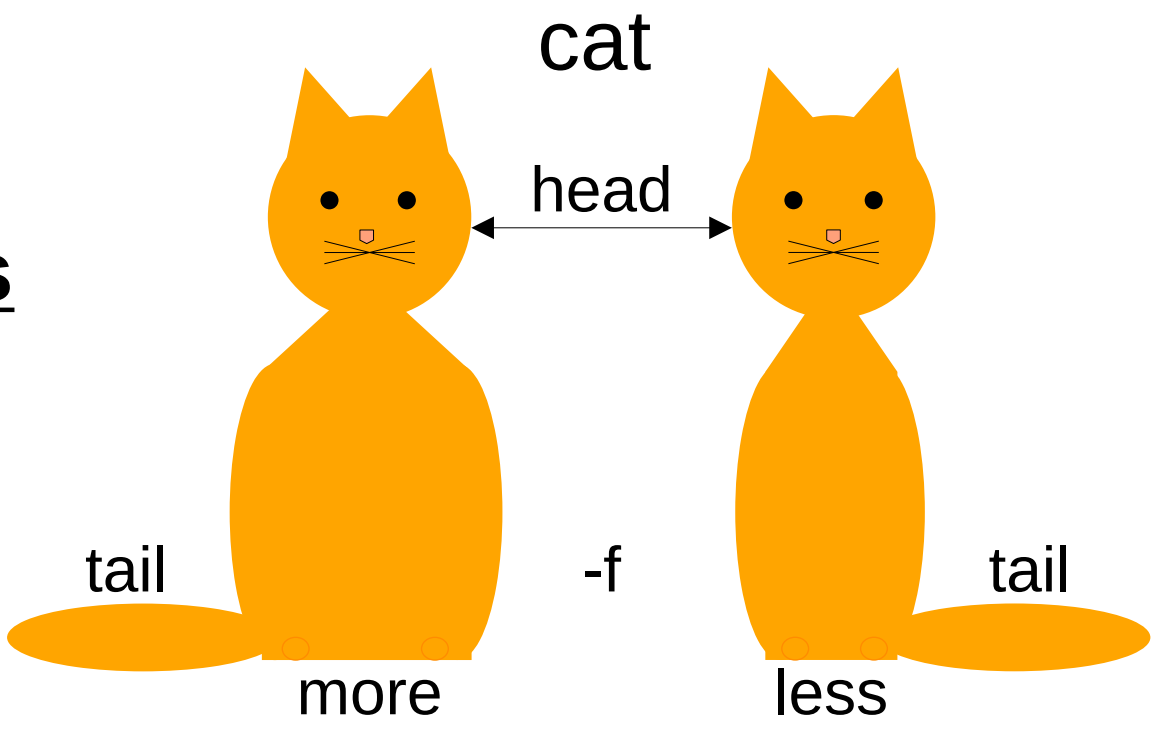
Linux Logs

Path

/var/log

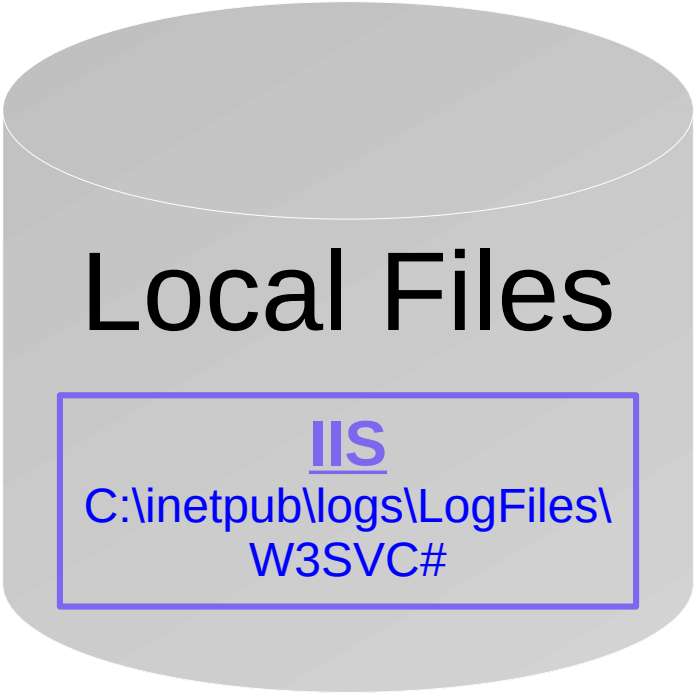
Epoch timestamps

01-01-1970



Server Logs


Host
Native
Logs

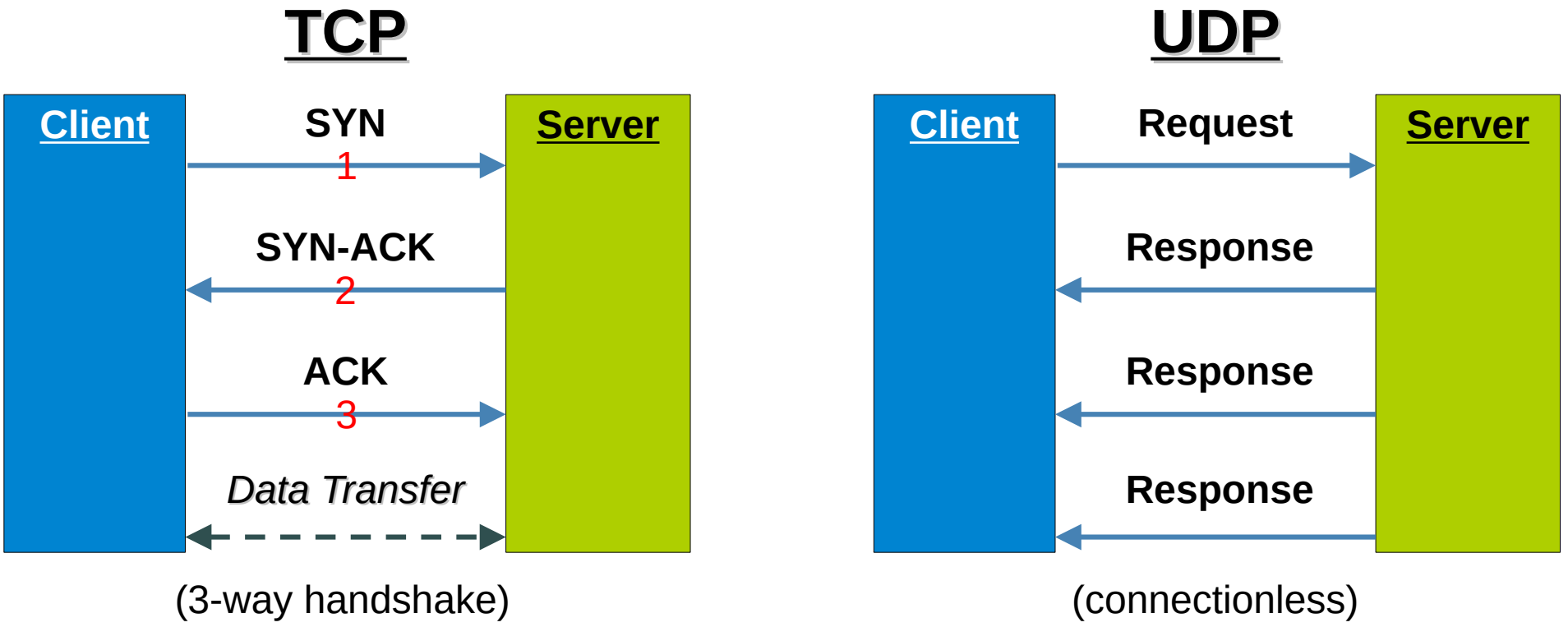

Local Files
IIS
C:\inetpub\logs\LogFiles\
W3SVC#

Application Logs



Centralized
Console

Network Transport Protocols



Computer Network Ports

TCP

22 (SSH)

80 (HTTP)

443 (HTTPS)

445 (SMB)

3389 (RDP)

UDP

53 (DNS)

67/68 (DHCP)

123 (NTP)

161 (SNMP)

Others



HTTP Request Methods

GET

HEAD

CONNECT

OPTIONS



POST

PUT

DELETE

TRACE

PATCH

HTTP Response Codes



200 series *(“Ok” codes)*

300 series *(redirects)*

400 series *(client errors)*

500 series *(server errors)*

OWASP Top 10

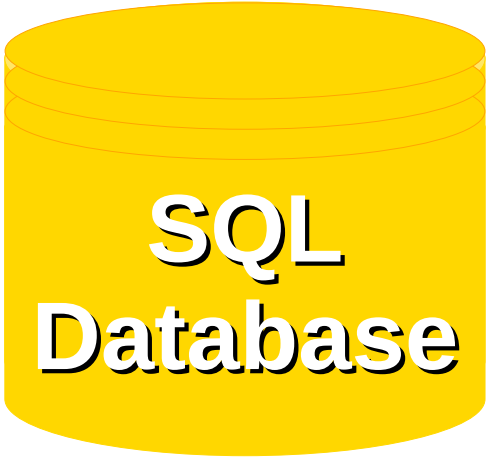


Open Web Application Security Project, Top 10

Structured Query Language

Free online training

- https://www.sqlcourse.com/beginner-course/
- https://www.sqlcourse.com/advanced-course/



Data Encoding

String	Hello attendees!
Base64	SGVsbG8gYXR0ZW5kZWVzIQ==
ROT13	Uryyb nggraqrrf!
HEX (from ASCII)	48 65 6c 6c 6f 20 61 74 74 65 6e 64 65 65 73 21

NOTE:	All 3 encoding methods are commonplace

IOCs & TTPs

Indicators of Compromise

- **Filenames & Paths**
- **Hashes**
- **IP addresses**
- **Domains & URLs**

File Execution?

Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

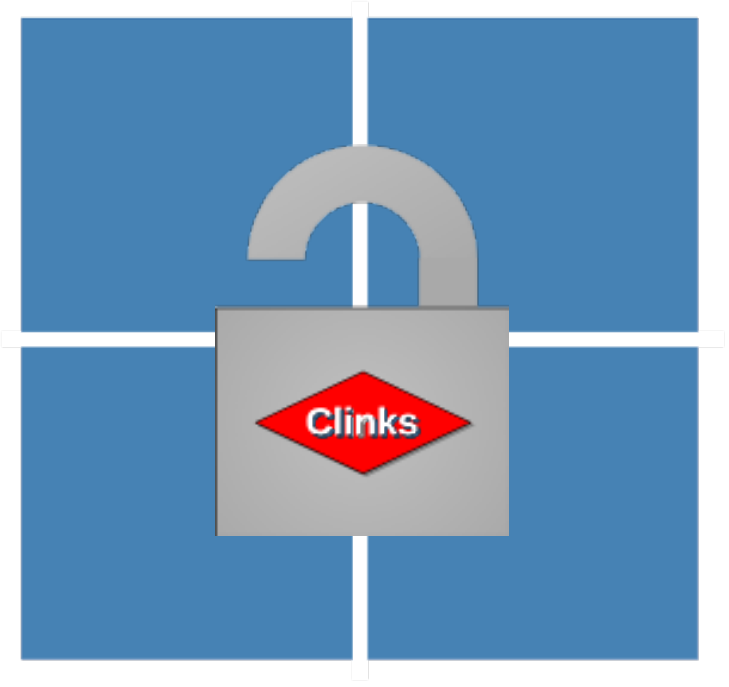
- **MITRE ATT&CK** framework
  - **https://attack.mitre.org**

Persistence
TA0003

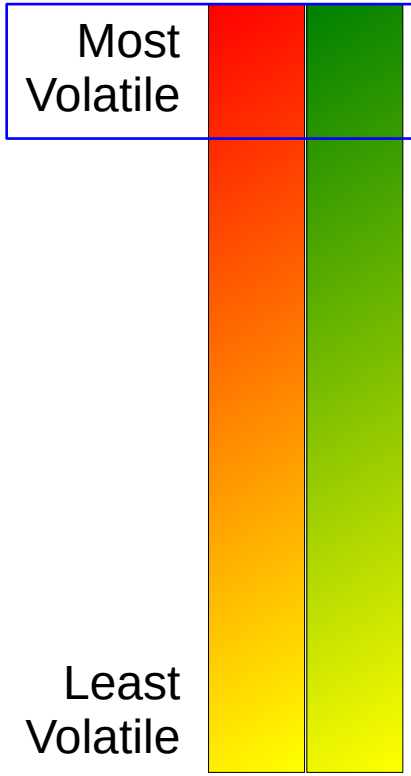
Windows Design & Security

50+ auto-executable file extensions

Ready!
Fire!
Aim?
...Whoops!!!



Volatile Data Collection



Highest Priority

Lowest Priority

Order of Volatility

FIFO = First In, First Out

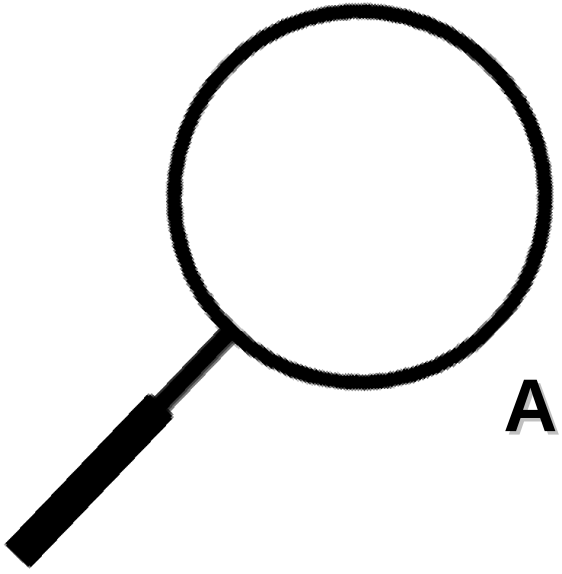
Industry Standards

RFC 3227

NIST SP 800-86

Digital Forensics

https://youtu.be/t4Vy3irI0Tk



These Artifacts Aren’t Fiction

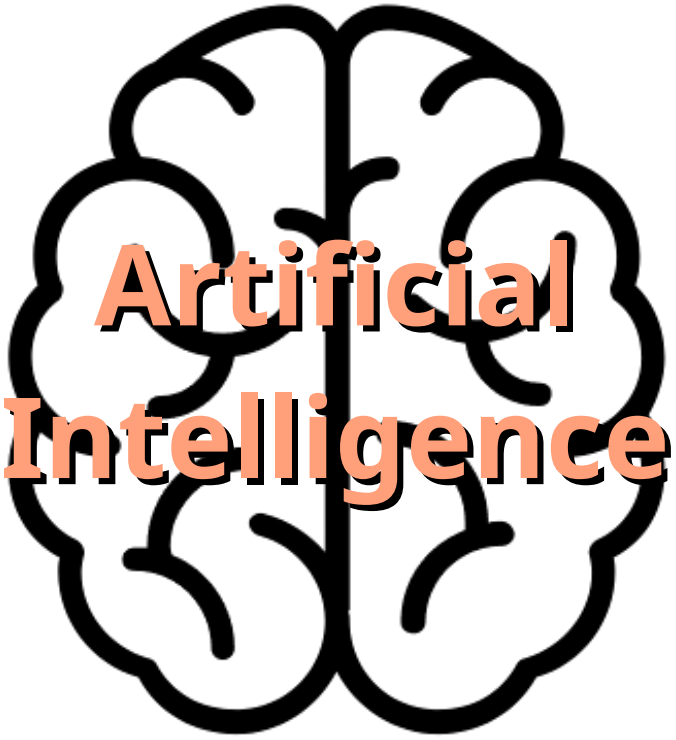
Cloud Security

https://youtu.be/0vijJ7r-c8s



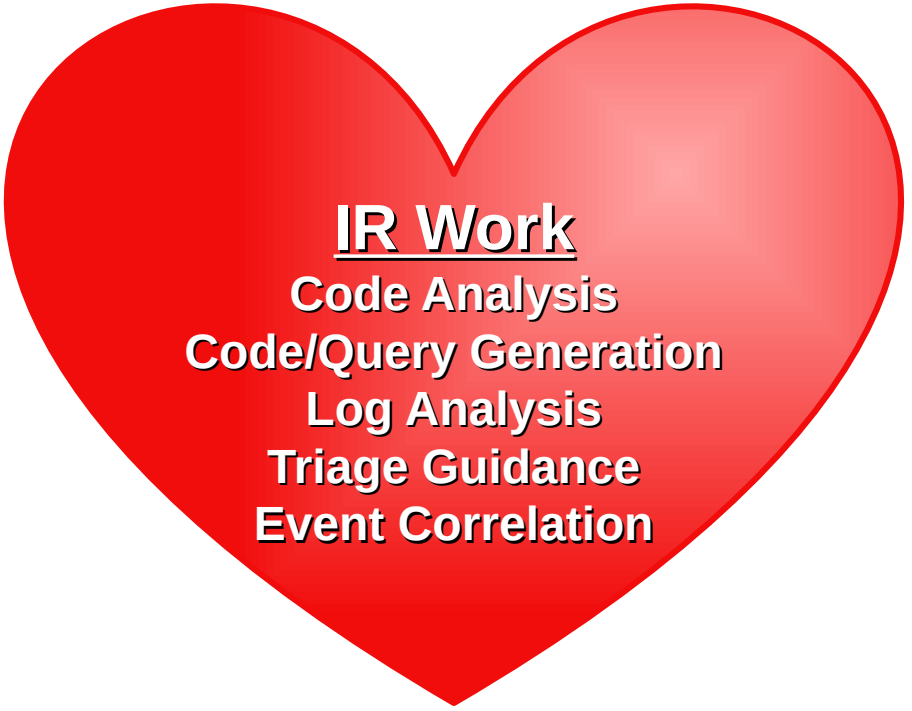
“The New Hotness”



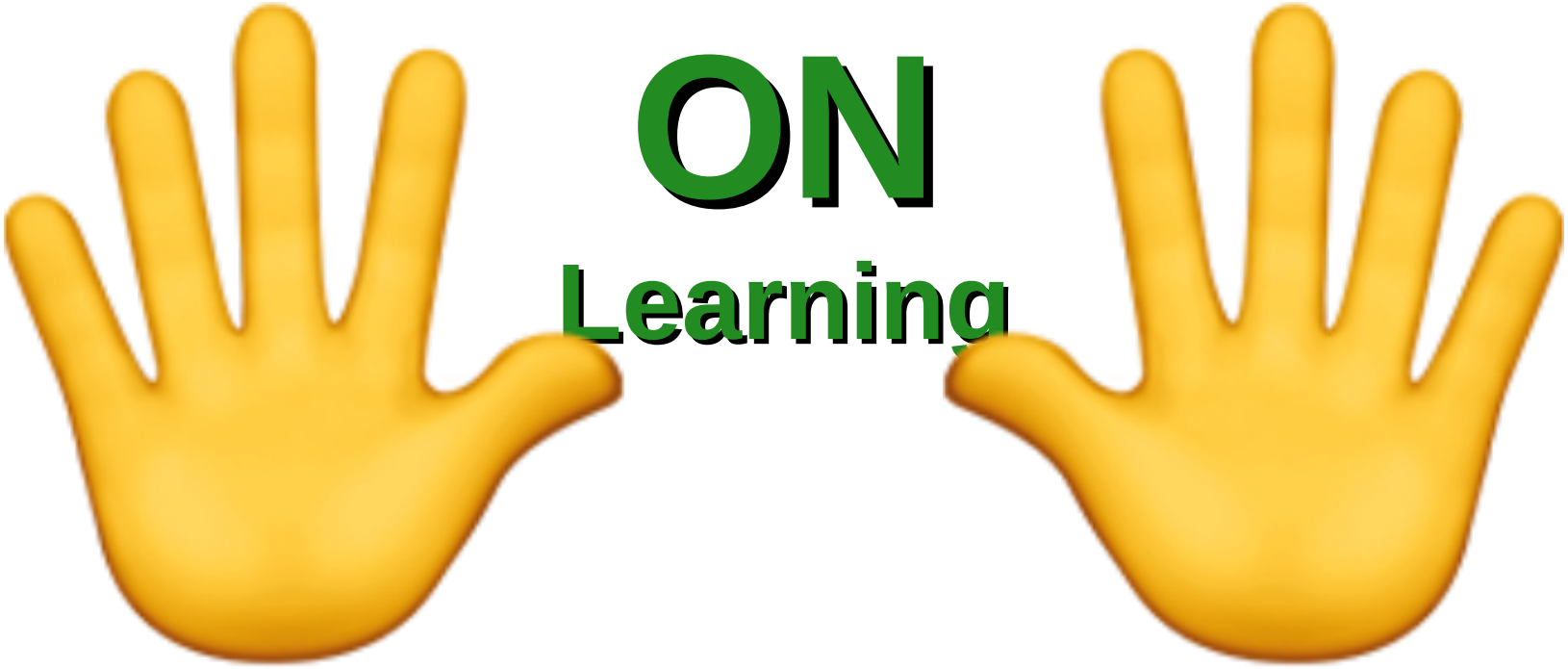


Ways (A)I Benefited





The Best Way to Learn



ON

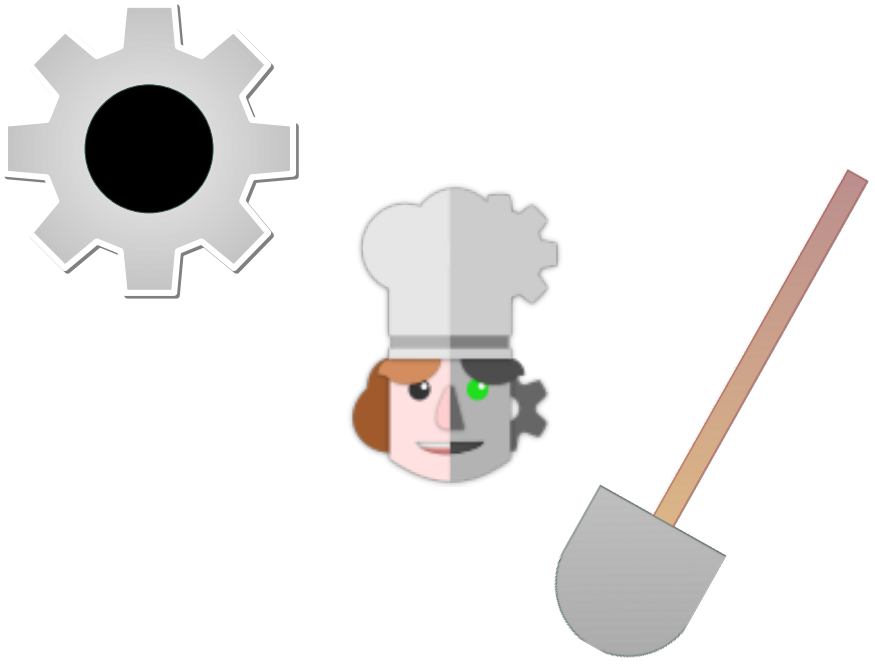
Learning

Network Packet Analysis



https://workshops.dfirmatt.com

CyberChef



https://workshops.dfirmatt.com

Kusto Query Language

KQL

https://workshops.dfirmatt.com

Tools to Learn

- Incident Response & Forensics tools in
  - **Kali Linux** (Yes, really!)
  - **REMnux** (Linux)
  - **SANS SIFT Workstation** (Linux)
  - **CSI Linux**
  - **FireEye's FLARE VM** (Windows)

IR Ride Along

https://youtu.be/kjf-fBrSzVA



Questions



Who?

What?

When?

Where?

Why?

How?





Becoming an IR Rock Star

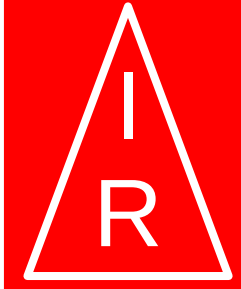
(Superstars 2.0)



Matt Scheurer

October 16, 2026






```
if (badEvent == "true") {
  perform = "Incident Response";
}
```

